CAROS

PLUMBING / WORKSHEET + 10 TEXT TEMPLATES

The After-Hours Revenue Calculator Worksheet

Find the calls that fall through. Give the next caller a clear next step.



REVENUE FIRST. / A PRACTICAL GUIDE FOR PLUMBERS

Your phone stopped ringing. Did the opportunity stop, too?

It is 8:43 p.m. You are finishing a water-heater job. Someone across town has water on the floor.

Your voicemail takes the call. Their search continues.

None of these are failures of skilled plumbers. They're failures of process.

This worksheet helps you estimate the opportunity behind unanswered calls, choose a response workflow, and measure what happens next. It includes ten text templates your team can adapt.

Revenue first. Start with your own call log, not a scary industry statistic.

Bring: one complete month's call records, booking records, completed-job revenue, and current communication costs.

Write down:

- Business: _____
- Month reviewed: _____
- After-hours window: _____
- Person accountable for callbacks: _____
- Backup person: _____

All worked figures in this guide are hypothetical planning inputs. They are not CAROS customer results, industry benchmarks, or promised recoveries.

Count opportunities, not rings

One homeowner calling three times is one opportunity. A supplier calling after closing is not a new plumbing lead.

Review each unanswered after-hours call. Remove spam, suppliers, duplicate attempts, existing-job updates, and requests outside your service area. Keep existing customers with a genuinely new service request.

Call-log field	Your entry
Date and local time	_____
Contact or opportunity ID	_____
New service request?	Yes / No / Unknown
Service area and job type	_____
Original lead source, if known	_____
First acknowledgement time	_____
First human response time	_____
Outcome	Booked / Lost / Open / Ineligible
Completed-job revenue	_____

Count unknowns separately. Do not silently assume every unknown was a lost emergency job.

A. Unique, eligible after-hours opportunities without a live answer: _____

B. Of A, opportunities already recovered through callbacks: _____

C. Opportunities still unresolved or lost: A − B = _____

Check that B is a subset of A. Keep this same cohort throughout the worksheet.

Put a range around the opportunity

Use completed jobs, not the largest estimate you remember.

D. Assumed share of C that an improved workflow could turn into additional completed jobs: _____%

E. Average collected revenue per comparable completed job: $_____

Modeled additional completed jobs = C × D

Modeled additional monthly revenue = C × D × E

Example: 20 eligible unanswered opportunities minus 5 already recovered leaves 15.

15 × 20% assumed additional completion rate × $450 average collected job revenue = $1,350 modeled monthly revenue.

That is a scenario, not proof that $1,350 was lost or will be recovered. Some callers would never book. Others may already have hired someone.

Scenario	C	Assumed completion rate D	Average revenue E	C × D × E
Cautious example	15	10%	$450	$675
Working example	15	20%	$450	$1,350
Higher example	15	30%	$450	$2,025
Your cautious case	___	___%	$___	$___
Your working case	___	___%	$___	$___

Use your own assumptions. A constant monthly scenario multiplied by twelve is an annual illustration, not a seasonal forecast.

Revenue is not profit

Now account for the work required to earn it.

F. Contribution margin after incremental job costs: _____%

G. Added monthly response costs: $_____

Include software, messaging, answering coverage, implementation allocation, and added callback labor. Do not count costs twice.

Modeled monthly contribution after response costs = (C × D × E × F) − G

Example: $1,350 modeled revenue × 40% assumed contribution margin − $250 response costs = $290 modeled contribution.

The $450 ticket, 40% margin, and $250 costs are worksheet assumptions. They are not CAROS prices or plumbing benchmarks.

Break-even additional jobs = G ÷ (E × F), rounded up

Example: $250 ÷ ($450 × 40%) = 1.39. Round up to 2 additional completed jobs.

Your break-even: $_____ ÷ ($_____ × _____%) = _____ jobs, rounded up.

If your schedule is full, review capacity before seeking more bookings. Overtime and extra travel may change the calculation.

Build the handoff before the auto-reply

A text saying “we got your call” is a receipt. Someone still needs to own the conversation.

1. Detect an unanswered inbound call.
2. Check whether a response is appropriate and permitted. Suppress duplicates and opted-out contacts.
3. Send one accurate acknowledgement under your business name.
4. Create a callback task with an owner and due time.
5. Alert the on-call person during staffed coverage. Otherwise state the next staffed callback window.
6. Stop generic follow-up when the caller replies, books, declines, or opts out.
7. Record the final outcome and completed-job revenue.

Our staffed coverage: _____

Our promised callback window: _____

Our escalation route if that window is missed: _____

Our approved response for situations we cannot serve: _____

Do not describe an automated inbox as emergency dispatch. Do not promise arrival until a person checks availability. For immediate danger, direct callers to appropriate emergency services; do not diagnose hazards by automated text.

Test during business hours and after closing. Include a withheld number, repeated calls, an opt-out, and a reply while the on-call person is unavailable.

Five texts for the first response

Replace every bracketed field before activation. Use only templates that match your actual coverage. An inbound call is not blanket permission for promotional campaigns. Have your messaging provider confirm consent, registration, opt-out handling, and applicable requirements for your setup.

1. Busy on another job

“[Business]: Sorry we missed your call. What plumbing issue can we help with, and what ZIP code are you in? A team member will reply within [staffed window]. Reply STOP to opt out.”

2. After hours with staffed coverage

“[Business]: We missed your call. Our on-call team is available until [time]. Please reply with your issue and ZIP code. Dispatch and arrival require confirmation. STOP to opt out.”

3. After hours without live coverage

“[Business]: Our office is closed. We return calls starting [day/time]. This inbox is not monitored for emergencies. If you need immediate service, contact an available provider. STOP to opt out.”

4. Weekend callback

“[Business]: Thanks for calling. Our next staffed callback window is [day/time]. Reply with your issue and preferred callback number. An appointment is not yet confirmed. STOP to opt out.”

5. Service-area check

“[Business]: Sorry we missed you. What ZIP code needs service? Our team will check coverage and availability during [staffed window]. STOP to opt out.”

Five texts for a clearer next step

6. Existing customer with a new request

“[Business]: Sorry we missed your call. Is this about an existing appointment or a new plumbing issue? We'll route your reply to the right person during [staffed window]. STOP to opt out.”

7. Water-heater inquiry

“[Business]: Thanks for calling about water-heater service. Reply with your ZIP code and a brief description. A team member will discuss inspection options during [staffed window]. STOP to opt out.”

8. Drain-service inquiry

“[Business]: Sorry we missed your drain-service call. Which fixture is affected, and what ZIP code are you in? Our team will review your request during [staffed window]. STOP to opt out.”

9. Booking link with checked availability

“[Business]: Sorry we missed you. For non-emergency appointments, view current openings here: [booking link]. You'll receive confirmation after booking. Questions? Reply here. STOP to opt out.”

10. One unanswered-callback check-in

“[Business]: Following up on your service request. Do you still need help, or should we close it? Reply here during [staffed window]. STOP to opt out.”

Use template 10 only when the follow-up is appropriate for that service inquiry. Do not keep sending it. A decline closes the sequence. An opt-out suppresses future automated texts through your configured process.

Review the week. Then measure the leak.

At your next team check-in, ask:

- How many unique eligible calls lacked a live answer?
- How many acknowledgements were delivered?
- How long did the first human response take?
- How many people replied, booked, completed, or declined?
- How much collected revenue came from those completed jobs?
- What did the response workflow cost?
- Which promises did we miss?

Count a booked appointment and a completed job separately. Keep a recovered lead's original marketing source. Add “missed-call response” as an assisted touch, rather than inventing a new source.

Your observed results will not prove every job was caused by automation. They will show whether the process is working and where to investigate next.

This week's change: _____

Owner and review date: _____

You paid for that lead. Give it an accountable next step.

Automation where it makes sense, humans where they matter.

Measure your opportunity: open the CAROS Revenue Leakage Calculator and compare scenarios using your worksheet inputs.

Find the process behind the number: get your Free Business Audit. Explore both tools at getcaros.com/en/resources.